

QUICK GUIDE · PROGRAMS FOR VETERANS

Veteran Jobs & Business Support

Whether you want a good job or to start your own business, there's free training, hiring help, and funding built for veterans. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Veterans get priority at job centers and dedicated business programs. Much of this is free. Veteran business certification can also unlock set-aside government contracts.

1 Find a Job

Hiring help and priority services for veterans.

☐ VA Careers & Employment

VA's hub for job help, including the Veteran Readiness program.

→ www.va.gov/careers-employment

☐ CareerOneStop — Veterans

Free job search, training, and priority service at American Job Centers.

→ www.careeronestop.org/Veterans 1-877-872-5627

2 Train for a Career

Use your benefits and free programs to build skills.

☐ Veteran Readiness & Employment (VR&E)

Free training and job help for veterans with service-connected disabilities.

→ www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation

☐ Apprenticeships for Veterans

Earn while you learn, often using GI Bill benefits. See the Apprenticeships guide.

→ www.apprenticeship.gov/career-seekers

3 Start a Business

Dedicated free help for veteran entrepreneurs.

☐ Veterans Business Outreach Centers

Free business training and mentoring for veterans and military spouses.

→ www.sba.gov/local-assistance/resource-partners/veterans-business-outreach-center-vboc-program

☐ Boots to Business

Free SBA entrepreneurship course for the military community.

→ www.sba.gov/event/boots-business

4 Win Government Contracts

Certification reserves contracts for veteran-owned firms.

☐ Veteran-Owned Small Business Certification

Free certification to compete for veteran set-aside federal contracts.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/veteran-contracting-assistance-programs

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be wary of “veteran job placement” or “business grant” services that charge fees — the programs above are free. And never pay to get certified as a veteran-owned business; the official process is free.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Mention your veteran status everywhere — you get priority at American Job Centers, many employers actively recruit veterans, and VBOCs give free, veteran-specific business coaching.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your nearest Job Center and VBOC, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
